

# **Team teaching material**

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# 1 Welcome

This site is built with Quarto as a **book** project. Use the table of contents to open the Linux installation guide.

Download the compiled book as a single PDF: [team-teaching-material.pdf](#).

For other materials in this repository (SNF, Git, package development, etc.), see the project `README.md` in the repository root.



## 2 Install core software on Ubuntu

- `dpkg --print-architecture`: retrieve architecture, for package installation<sup>1</sup>.
- `Ctrl-H` in **G**nome, aka File Management, to list hidden files

### 2.1 Ubuntu general guidelines

#### 2.1.1 Recommended system libraries to install

```
# Install system libs
sudo apt-get update
sudo apt-get install -y \
    apt-transport-https \
    build-essential \
    ca-certificates \
    cloud-guest-utils \
    curl \
    default-jre \
    f2c \
    gdebi-core \
    gnupg \
    libbz2-dev \
    libcurl4-openssl-dev \
```

---

<sup>1</sup>Returns `amd64` in my case

## 2 Install core software on Ubuntu

```
libffi-dev \  
libfontconfig1-dev \  
libfribidi-dev \  
libgsl0-dev \  
libgtextutils-dev \  
libharfbuzz-dev \  
libicu-dev \  
liblzma-dev \  
libncurses5-dev \  
libncursesw5-dev \  
libpcre3 \  
libpcre3-dev \  
libperl-dev \  
libreadline-dev \  
libssl-dev \  
libtiff-dev \  
libxml2-dev \  
locales \  
ncftp \  
pandoc \  
parallel \  
pkg-config \  
readline-doc \  
sudo \  
tcl \  
tk \  
tk-dev \  
tk-table \  
tmux \  
tzdata \  
unzip \  
vim \  
&& sleep 1
```

## 2.1.2 Ubuntu file, and package structure

### 2.1.2.1 System-wide location (for core programs)

System-wide affects all users, are installed using `sudo`, on the root of the system.

| Location                    | Purpose                                                                        |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>/usr/bin</code>       | System executables (APT)                                                       |
| <code>/etc</code>           | System-wide configuration (example: define repositories for <code>apt</code> ) |
| <code>/opt</code>           | Vendor (external) apps                                                         |
| <code>/usr/local/bin</code> | Admin-installed software                                                       |
| <code>/var</code>           | Logs, caches, databases                                                        |

Table 2.1: Main system-wide software locations

- `/opt` for third-party application bundles, **self-contained** while `/usr/local` is for third-party **binaries**. Besides, `/opt` is not in the path by default.

### 2.1.2.2 User-specific locations

User does not require root

| Location                     | Purpose                 |
|------------------------------|-------------------------|
| <code>~/Applications</code>  | AppImages               |
| <code>~/.local/bin</code>    | User executables        |
| <code>~/scripts/tools</code> | Custom bash executables |

2 Install core software on Ubuntu

| Location       | Purpose                                                                        |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ~/.local/share | User app data, notably<br>~/.local/share/applications storing<br>desktop icons |
| ~/.config      | User configuration                                                             |

Table 2.2: Main user-based software locations, to be compared with Table 2.1

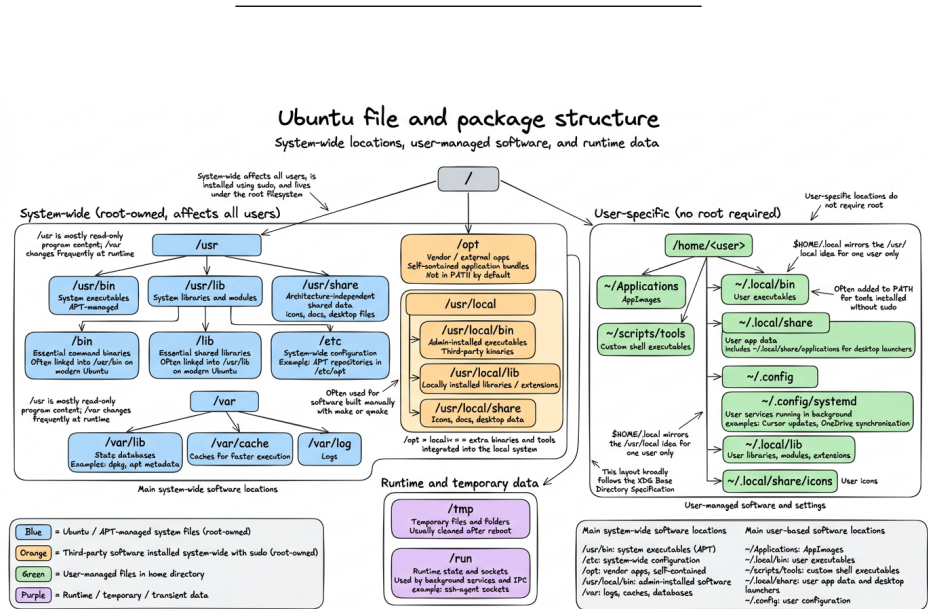


Figure 2.1: Detailed structure of Ubuntu package layout

### **i** Specific folders

- `usr` folder stores *read-only* executables, while `/var` is regularly written upon changes:
  - `/var/lib`: apt and dpkg databases, for instance, respectively stored under `dpkg`, and `/apt`
  - `/var/cache`: metadata caches for faster execution
- `/usr/local/`, or `$HOME/.local` stores executables that require custom compilation with `make`, or `qmake`, rendered from manual archives:
  - `bin`, `sbin` for executables
  - `share` for icons (under subfolder `icons`) and desktop configuration, document ion under `/doc`
  - `lib` for extensions of a given executable (such as packages in R, or modules in Python)
  - This folder hierarchy follows XGDBase Directory Npecification
- `/tmp` for temporary folders, cleaned after `reboot`
- `/run` for sockets, namely used for controlling all the protocols running in the background for connecting to a server, such as the `ssh-agent`
- `~/.config/systemd`: lists all processes that keep on running in the background, such as Cursor updates, or One drive synchronisations.

### 2.1.3 Recommended Updating policy of Ubuntu

1. Create file `update_os.sh` with:

## 2 Install core software on Ubuntu

```
#!/bin/bash
rm -rf /var/lib/dpkg/lock-frontent
rm -rf /var/lib/dpkg/lock
apt-get update
apt-get upgrade -y
apt-get dist-upgrade -y
apt-get autoremove -y
apt-get autoclean -y
```

### 2. Run having sudorights

- i. `chmod +x update_os.sh` to provide executive rights
- ii. `sudo ./update_os.sh` to run the update file with **admin** rights

### 3. Reboot the system with `reboot`

#### Ubuntu partial updates

Partial updates breaking key driver components occur more often with Ubuntu compared to Microsoft, since Linux tends to provide lots of separate, modular packages while Windows ships large and standalone bundles -> **Consequence: more issues with updates, especially if the network connection dropped, and the newest versions of the packages were not fully installed.**

---

General recommendations:



## 2.1 Ubuntu general guidelines

```
# to be run daily
sudo apt update
sudo apt upgrade

# to be run monthly
sudo apt full-upgrade

## clean deprecated dependencies
sudo apt autoremove
sudo apt autoclean
```

---

Deal driver issues

```
## Check for Broken Packages
sudo dpkg --configure -a
## Install missing dependencies
sudo apt -f install

## List all Hardware Driver Errors
dmesg -l err,crit,alert,emerg
```

### 2.1.4 Monitor processes running in the background, and on startup

- `systemctl list-unit-files --type=service --state=running --user` to list all processes running in the background, even after rebooting, restrained to the user-level.
  - Alternatively, processes at the system-level are stored under `/lib/systemd/system/`

## 2 Install core software on Ubuntu

- `systemctl status <service>` retrieves current status

### 2.1.5 Network protocols, and connexion troubleshoots

- Two IP protocols for Wi-Fi: IPv4 versus IPv6.



The two Internet protocols, namely IPv4 vs IPv6

IPv4 is older, but still prevailing in many websites, such as Github, or OneDrive:

- Uses 32-bit addresses (e.g. 192.168.1.10)
- Used by **most websites**, CDNs, VPNs, corporate services
- But the 32-limitation hinders the number of available IP addresses.

IPv6 is newer, but not universally supported:

- Uses 128-bit addresses (e.g. 2a01:cb14:86a7::1)
- Supported by modern ISPs and operating systems
- Some networks provide **IPv6-only**, with no IPv4 fallback. Especially the case with Microsoft services, governmental or academic websites.

- You can test if this is the issue to connect to some websites with `curl <webdomain>`, such as `curl https://onedrive.live.com`, returning *Cannot connect*
- Recent modern routers return only IPv6 -> while Windows is able to auto-fall back to IPv4, this is not the case of IPv6.
  - *Temporary fix*: by running the following instructions, you solve this issue by automatically configuring a IPv4 upon failure. *Recommended only for short-term debugging.*

## 2.1 Ubuntu general guidelines

```
install dhclient commands
sudo dhclient -4 wlp2s0f0 <Wifi-name> ## in my case, wlp2s0f0
```

– *Permanent fix*<sup>2</sup>:

```
nmcli connection modify "Routeur/Livebox-FC77" ipv4.method auto
nmcli connection modify "Routeur/Livebox-FC77" ipv6.method auto ## connect automatically to
## re-start the connection, applying the new configuration parameters
nmcli connection down "Routeur/Livebox-FC77"
nmcli connection up "Routeur/Livebox-FC77"
```

### 2.1.5.1 Eduroam connexion

0. **Ensure to delete beforehand any pre-existing installation:**  
`rm -rf $HOME/.config/cat_installer.`
1. Go to <https://cat.eduroam.org/>, the website usually provides with the version fitting your OS distribution.
2. On Linux, download the Python script, choosing AMU university.
3. Run Python script with `python 3 eduroam-linux-AUA.py`
4. As `userid`, provide your academic mail address, and as `password`, your ENT password.

### 2.1.6 Pimp your shell: switch from boring Bash to fancy Zsh

1. Installation script:

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt install zsh

## change the default shell shebang
chsh -s $(which zsh) ## modify /etc/passwd repository
```

---

<sup>2</sup>Alternatively, you can rely on the GNOME Interface, Wifi section

## 2 Install core software on Ubuntu

```
reboot # required log out for effective changes

## check if zsh is used by default (also the theme is modified)
getent passwd "$USER" -> return "/home/bastien:/usr/bin/zsh"

## Install advanced customisation of the shell with Install Oh My Zsh addon
sh -c "$(curl -fsSL https://raw.githubusercontent.com/ohmyzsh/ohmyzsh/master/tools/install.sh)"
```

**You should keep the original `~/.bashrc` as a fallback for Bash.**

### 2. Install the modern alternative to `ls`, namely `eza`

```
# install the gpg command
sudo apt update
sudo apt install -y gpg

# install eza
wget -qO- https://raw.githubusercontent.com/eza-community/eza/main/deb.asc | sudo gpg --dearmor -o /usr/share/keyrings/eza-keyring.gpg
echo "deb [signed-by=/usr/share/keyrings/eza-keyring.gpg] http://deb.gierens.de stable main" | sudo tee /etc/apt/sources.list.d/eza.list
sudo chmod 644 /usr/share/keyrings/eza-keyring.gpg /etc/apt/sources.list.d/eza.list
sudo apt update
sudo apt install -y eza
```

### 3. Change the behaviour of the shell:

- **System-wide:** all exe installed under `/usr` folder can be called directly from the `$PATH`. For third-party apps stored under `/opt`, you must **add a symlink** redirecting to your local folder: `sudo ln -s /opt/<appName> /usr/local/bin/<appName>`.
- **User-level:** customise `.bashrc` (and `.zshrc` if using the `.zshfancy` shebang) -> **Only affects the current user**, see my own `.zshrc` configuration file, and below `ls` output Figure 2.2.

## 2.1 Ubuntu general guidelines

(a) Modified behaviour of the `ls` output

(b) Modified behaviour of the `ll` output, displaying addition to file names their sizes, permission rights, and original proprietary

(c) The `la` output displays in addition to the `ll` output the hidden files (traitidionally starting with a `.`)

(d) The `lt` output is combination of both `ls` and `tree` to display the hierarchical structure of a folder

Figure 2.2: Visual representation of my customised `ls` commands to display the content of a folder from a Bash terminal.

## 2 Install core software on Ubuntu

Useful resources:

- shell shortcuts

## 2.2 Synchronise files across devices with OneDrive

### 2.2.1 OneDrive open-source installation for Ubuntu

1. Install dependencies:

```
sudo apt install build-essential libcurl4-openssl-dev pkg-config git -y
```

2. Add the openSUSE Build Service repository release key

```
wget -q0 - https://download.opensuse.org/repositories/home:/npreining:/debian-ubuntu/
echo "deb [arch=$(dpkg --print-architecture) signed-by=/usr/share/keyrings/obs-onedrive] https://download.opensuse.org/repositories/home:/npreining:/debian-ubuntu/
## update cache
sudo apt-get update
```

3. Install OneDrive:

```
sudo apt install --no-install-recommends --no-install-suggests onedrive
```

4. Sync OneDrive:

- i. Exclude large folders, and directories that are complex and are not recommended for syncing, `nano ~/.config/onedrive/config`. You can see the actual content of my config file under `onedrive-custom-config`.<sup>3</sup>
- ii. Authenticate, and run OneDrive once

---

<sup>3</sup>Note that **Comments must be placed in separated lines, not inline.**

## 2.2 Synchronise files across devices with OneDrive

```
onedrive --sync --dry-run ## optional, list folders that will be synchronised
onedrive --sync --verbose ## first initialisation, usually time-consuming, one-shot
```

4. Permanent synchronization using systemctl facilities. **Choose either this approach, or the visual approach detailed in Tip 1, as they can't operate simultaneously.**

```
systemctl --user enable onedrive
systemctl --user start onedrive ## in the back end, use onedrive --monitor
```

5. Monitor currently uploaded files:

```
journalctl --user-unit onedrive -f (continuous) ## equivalent to systemctl --user status onedrive (single)

onedrive --display-config
onedrive --version
```

6. Other useful OneDrive instructions:

- `onedrive --create-share-link <path/to/file>` for read-only shareable links, and `onedrive --create-share-link <path/to/file> --with-editing-perms` to add writing rights.

### Tip 1: GUIs for OneDrive monitoring

OneDrive system tray program adds a simple icon returning the status of synchronization for OneDrive.

Installation bash:

## 2 Install core software on Ubuntu

```
## install the 5th version of qmake
sudo apt install qt5-qmake qtbase5-dev

## create the runnable executive file
git clone https://github.com/DanielBorges0liveira/onedrive_tray.git
cd onedrive_tray
mkdir build
cd build
/usr/lib/qt5/bin/qmake ../systray.pro ## prepare the configuration, such as Makefile
make ## build the software

## execute it, such that it runs whenever log in
sudo make install ## deploy the software, such as copying files -> here's the sudo
systemctl enable --user onedrive_tray.service
```

Colour the logs output reported on the terminal:

1. Install dependencies: `sudo apt install silversearcher-ag ccze`
2. Add `onedrive_log` bash file into folder `~/scripts/tools`.
3. Add permanently to the `$PATH` by modifying the `~/.bashrc` file:  
`export PATH="$PATH:$HOME/scripts/tools/"`

### 2.2.2 Troubleshoots for OneDrive

- Call `systemctl --user restart onedrive` after modifying the `.config` file to account for changes within it. For retro-application of configuration changes, use `onedrive --resync --sync --verbose` with parsimony. The synchronisation halts without warning, when the config file is modified, so you need to restart it.



## 2.2 Synchronise files across devices with OneDrive

- Warning “onedrive application is already running, please check process list” means that several concurrent onedrive are running in the background:
  - List existing processes using onedrive: `ps aux | grep onedrive`
  - Force kill processes that do not use `systemctl`: `kill -9`
  - 90% of the time is that you’re simultaneously running UI OneDrive, and in the background `systemctl` for synchronising processes

### **i** OneDrive, Git and EOL encoding across OS

Git and OneDrive do not combine well for:

- **Different encoding of end of line:** Linux (and Mac) machines end lines with LF (Line Feed): `\n`, while Windows uses CRLF (Carriage Return + Lien Feed): `\r\n`
- Linux tracks file permissions for executables while Windows doesn’t (only problematic for shell scripts)
- `.git` and `.Rproj` folders are complex binary repositories often OS dependent.

---

To avoid these issues:

- i. Configure globally the `.gitconfig` configuration file to allow both end of lines indicators, using `git config --global core.autocrlf input` on Linux and Mac machines collaborating with Windows machines<sup>4</sup>, and `git config --global core.autocrlf true` on Windows machines<sup>5</sup>.
- ii. For further robustness, create a `.gitattributes` dotfile per project<sup>6</sup>:

## 2 Install core software on Ubuntu

```
## 3 columns: file extension, file type (text, or binary), eol definition for text
*.sh  text eol=lf
*.py  text eol=lf
*.js  text eol=lf
*.ts  text eol=lf
*.java text eol=lf
```

Then, apply the changes with the following Git commands<sup>^</sup>[this command first identifies

```
git add --renormalize .
git status ## display files being impacted by the change of EOL encoding
git commit -m "Normalize line endings"
```

iii. Configure the editor default end of line encoding:

- *VS Code*: Shift-Ctrl-P, then type “Open VS Code Settings”, then go to “Files:EOL”, and set end of line as \n
  - *RStudio*: Tools → Global Options → Code → Saving -> Line ending Conversion → (Posix) LF.
-

## 2.2 Synchronise files across devices with OneDrive

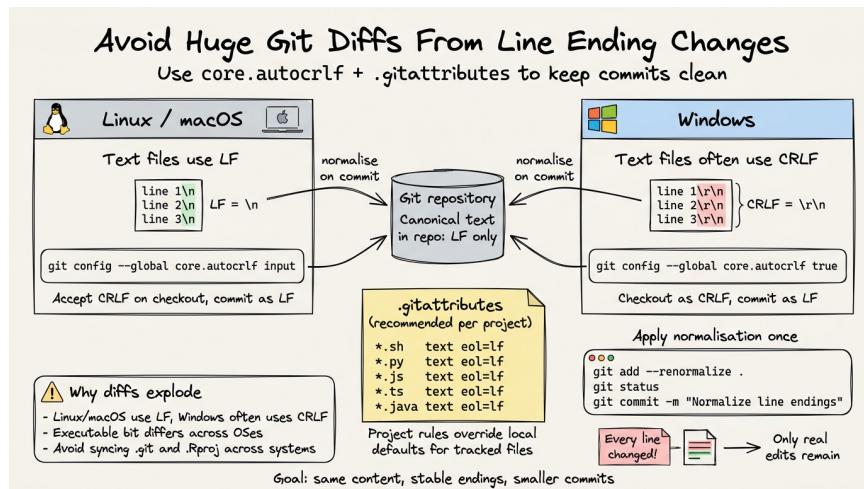


Figure 2.3: Best practices for End of Line homogenisation across devices

### ⚠ Graphical Interfaces for OneDrive

Avoid using graphical interfaces, such as OneDriveGUI, they poorly concur with local installation of `onedrive` on my personal experiment. Instead, rely on the terminal, as it usually provides the user with better customisation, and control on OneDrive configuration.

### ⚠ Compatibility with Applications Using Atomic Save Operations

Many modern editors, such as LibreOffice and Rstudio use **atomic**

<sup>6</sup>Accept as EOL CRLF, but always commit as LF.

<sup>6</sup>constrain commits to be encoded and pushed as LF

<sup>6</sup>Detailed information is available here

## 2 Install core software on Ubuntu

```
file.qmd
↓ edit
file.qmd.tmp ## If OneDrive synchronises in the meantime, it believes that the file
↓ rename
file.qmd

## Architecture causing this problem
RStudio
|
| save
▼
Local file (.qmd)
|
| filesystem event
▼
onedrive client
|
| sync
▼
OneDrive cloud
|
| sync back
▼
local overwrite
```

This process is likely to interfere with the regular synchronisation protocol of the **onedrive** client relying on **inotify**, triggering editor warnings, or even temporary removal of files contents.

Three complementary solutions to address these issues, and reduce conflicts between editor saves and sync detection.

1. Do not put active projects inside **OneDrive**, setting apart large

documents storage synchronised with OneDrive, from source code version by Git.

2. Pause sync while coding. **But you need to think about restarting the synchronisation afterwards.**
3. Twist the configuration file, helping with editors using atomic saves:

```
force_session_upload = "true" ## avoid overwriting by older cloud versions, when RStudio is on its v  
delay_inotify_processing = "true" ## wait for RStudio to finalise the saving of tmp files before syn
```

## 2.3 Software to install

**\*\*General recommendation\*:** avoid using ChatGPT, as the instructions for installing software are often deprecated and/or not following Ubuntu best guidelines.

**i** Note 1: Install software on Ubuntu, some guidelines

Three recommended methods, depending on Ubuntu's support:

1. If supported by Ubuntu, go for `apt install` for system software<sup>7</sup>:
  - *automatic updates* and security patches -> **it's the only method allowing it in a systematic way.**
  - easiest method for installation
  - signed and verified packages
  - recommended for *core system*, long-term software
- If not directly available on Ubuntu's native package manager, or using in the back-end `snap` commands, switch

to pre-built tarball installation<sup>8</sup>, or add the repository (only if **trusted**) to `apt allowed keys` folder. Example for `Docker`, Section 2.3.6, or custom Zotero installation file.

- **.deb files** are intended for Linux distributions derived from Debian (such as Ubuntu, Linux Mint, etc.), while **.rpm files** are mainly used by distributions derived from Red Hat-based systems (such as Fedora, CentOS, and RHEL) + openSUSE distribution:
  - No auto-updates
  - Potential dependency issues
  - **Always install with `sudo apt install`, rather than `sudo dpkg -i`, to better solve dependencies, fix broken installs, and ensures system consistency.**

---

2. `AppImages` are standalone executable files, bundling the application and most of its dependencies:

- Recommended for *desktop applications* to be installed only on the user account -> does not require `sudo` rights in most cases
- Portable
- `AppImageLauncher` can help in organising all `AppImages` within the same folder + integrate them into the system menus:
  - Relevant if using multiple `AppImages`
  - Avoid `Snap`

---

3. Pre-built tarball (`.tar(gz|xz)`) archives:

- Stronger customisation

## 2.3 Software to install

- Works without distribution packages
- Requires manual handling/no automatic updates
- **Only recommended for developers, or if nothing else exists.**

- And now, the least recommended installations:
  - snap stores pre-compiled versions of tools, but are less recommended compared to standard installation with `sudo apt install`
  - FlatPak+Flathub

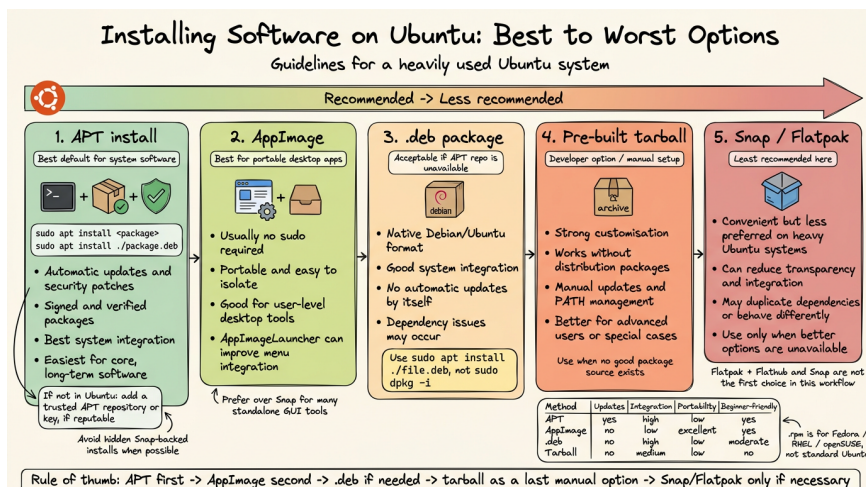


Figure 2.4: Guidelines for installing software on Ubuntu

portable, or not. Portable installation is easier to remove, as it does not leave leftovers in the core system, but does not allow for automatic updates. On the other hand, non-portable applications are usually better for daily/intensive use, but not *sandboxed*, and harder to remove.

### 2.3.1 Git and GitHub configuration

1. Github often requires double authentication, that you can set on <https://github.com/settings/security>. Recommended to use *passkey* if supported by your device (unfortunately, Linux OS usually do not support it), or use authenticator app, such as Microsoft Authenticator. **Deterred against the use of SMS + mobile phones.**
2. Configure your access to Github:
  - i. Choose either SSH, or HTTPs.
  - ii. For HTTPS, configure one token per device, under <https://github.com/settings/tokens>. Give the token the name of your laptop, its configuration and originals owner. Assign it at least the repo and read scopes. Copy it once -> **it won't be available afterwards!!**.
3. General options to configure:
  - i. Use either the command line (create also automatically the file `~/.gitconfig`):

```
git config --global user.name "bastienchassagnol"
git config --global user.email "bastien.chassagnol@univ-amu.fr"
```

<sup>8</sup>`apt-get` works similarly, but is now deprecated

<sup>8</sup>Fetch the latest stable archive, extract it, and add executables to your `PATH`, see example under Section 2.3.12



## 2.3 Software to install

- ii. Or directly, using text editor, file `~/.gitconfig` (more error-prone to indentation errors). Find my default git config file here (for comprehensive description of options, report to Formation Git 2024, a tutorial by Benjamin):

```
[user]
  name = bastienchassagnol
  email = bastien.chassagnol@univ-amu.fr
## modern default git options
[init]
  defaultBranch = main

## simplifying solving git conflicts + troubleshoot solving
[merge]
  conflictstyle = zdiff3
[rerere]
  enabled = true

## tolerate distinct end of lines
[core]
  autocrlf = input

## visualisation
[tag]
  sort = version:refname
[branch]
  sort = -committerdate
[credential]
  helper = store
```

4. Avoid typing your password for every login:
  - i. For HTTPS + PAT token protocol, use `git config --global credential.helper store` for **permanent** registration of the pass-

## 2 Install core software on Ubuntu

- word (should we not encrypt the file??), or `git config --global credential.helper 'cache --timeout=3600'` for temporary access<sup>9</sup>.
- ii. Define SSH key.

### 2.3.2 AppImageLauncher

```
## download the .deb archive, with the proper architecture configuration
## https://github.com/TheAssassin/AppImageLauncher/releases/tag/v3.0.0-beta-3

sudo apt install appimagelauncher_3.0.0-beta-2-gha287.96cb937_amd64.deb

## update dependencies
sudo apt update
sudo apt install -f
```

- For deleting apps installed with AppImage Launcher, you'll need to delete both *Applications* folder, and `~/.local/share/applications/` that stores executables.

### 2.3.3 PDF management

#### 2.3.3.1 Sioyek as PDF Viewer

Sioyek is an open-source PDF viewer focusing on technical papers with mathematical formulas. Major uses cases are coloured *highlights* of text sections with `h` shortcut, smart jump to figures by clicking on them, and bookmark text sections with shortcut `b`.

1. Choose between portable (for isolated environment), or standard distribution under Sioyek releases

---

<sup>9</sup>Time-out units are reported in seconds, accordingly, this amounts to one hour

## 2.3 Software to install

2. Unzip the archive, within it, make it executable with `chmod +x`.
3. Run it

**i** A step-by-step tutorial for the installation from source an Ubuntu application, from downloading the archive to adding it to the Path, and to the Start program

To turn any exec into a **desktop application** on Ubuntu-GNOME, follow this steps:

1. Relocate everything under **/opt/sioyek**<sup>10</sup>. \*\*Note that the structure of a package may not follow exactly this of **sioyek**!!

```
## create required folders

sudo mkdir -p /opt/sioyek
sudo mkdir -p /etc/sioyek
sudo mkdir -p /usr/share/sioyek

## relocate, if not already done, the sioyek builds

### core executables
sudo cp ~/sioyek/build/sioyek /opt/sioyek/
sudo chmod +x /opt/sioyek/sioyek

### configuration files
sudo cp ~/sioyek/build/prefs.config /etc/sioyek/
sudo cp ~/sioyek/build/keys.config /etc/sioyek/
sudo cp -r ~/sioyek/build/shaders /usr/share/sioyek/
sudo cp ~/sioyek/build/tutorial.pdf /usr/share/sioyek/
```

3. Add a distinctive icon, and customise the native Ubuntu launcher ‘Gnome’

## 2 Install core software on Ubuntu

```
sudo mkdir -p /usr/share/icons/hicolor/256x256/apps ## folder to store the sioyek.  
  
sudo tee /usr/share/applications/sioyek.desktop > /dev/null <<'EOF'  
[Desktop Entry]  
Version=1.0  
Type=Application  
Name=Sioyek  
GenericName=PDF Viewer  
Comment=Fast keyboard-driven PDF viewer  
Exec=/opt/sioyek/sioyek %path to the sioyek exe  
Icon=sioyek  
Terminal=false  
Categories=Office;Viewer;  
MimeType=application/pdf;  
StartupNotify=true  
EOF  
  
## Refresh desktop database  
sudo update-desktop-database
```

4. (Optional) Make Sioyek the default **PDF viewer**, using either:

a. GUI method:

1. Right-click any PDF
2. **Properties** → **Open With**
3. Select **Sioyek**
4. Click **Set as default**

b. or the command line:

```
xdg-mime default sioyek.desktop application/pdf  
  
## to check default  
xdg-mime query default application/pdf
```

5. add to the Path, creating a symbolic link

```
sudo ln -s /opt/sioyek/sioyek /usr/local/bin/sioyek
```

### 2.3.3.2 Sejda for editing PDFs in an interactive way

- Web version
- Sedja *add-on* for Chrome

### 2.3.3.3 PDFtk

- To edit PDFs, if you prefer the command line.

## 2.3.4 Image Editors (to replace Paint on Windows)

Sorted from closest experience to Paint, to most generalist:

1. Drawing
  - i. Add Drawing to the apt repository of allowed PPAs: `sudo add-apt-repository ppa:cartes/drawing`
  - ii. Install running `sudo apt install drawing`
2. Libre Office Draw
3. Gimp (closer equivalent to Photoshop):

```
sudo apt install gimp
sudo apt install gimp-plugin-registry ## add extensions
```

4. Inkscape for generating **vectorial**, and fully deformable icons

---

<sup>10</sup>default repo for third-party apps, preventing conflicts with distributed, native packages

## 2 Install core software on Ubuntu

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt install inkscape
```

### 2.3.5 LibreOffice

1. Install main software (such as Libre Office Write, or Calc) with `sudo apt install libreoffice libreoffice-gtk3`
2. Relevant extensions, that you can add using **Tools -> Extensions**
  - i. Rotate Images in free text documents with *Rotate* extension
  - ii. Install dictionaries + extension Grammalecte and LanguageTool<sup>11</sup>.  
*needs to check if LanguageTool is truly relevant, is AI-based, but also resource-consuming.*

```
## French dictionary
sudo apt update
sudo apt install libreoffice-l10n-fr ## add French hyphenation
```

- iii. Install Latex extension
3. Fonts customisation:
  - i. Install core Windows fonts:

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt install ttf-mscorefonts-installer ## Install Microsoft core fonts
fc-cache -f -v ## rebuild font cache, such that the fonts now appear In Libre Office
```

---

<sup>11</sup>You may configure the Java version used by default under **Tools -> Options -> Advanced**

## 2.3 Software to install

- ii. Extra fonts installation<sup>12</sup>. Most popular fonts can be found under Every-Font GH repository:

```
mkdir -p ~/.local/share/fonts ## ensure personal fonts folder is created
wget -P ~/.local/share/fonts "https://raw.githubusercontent.com/serendipious/every-font/master/Century
fc-cache -f -v ## update font cache
```

### Core typographic options

The main stylistic variants of fonts you can play with are:

1. Weight (Light, Regular, Bold, ...)
2. Angle or shape of the letters (regular versus italic)
3. Width
4. Serif vs Sans-Serif. This property is structural to a font, for instance, Times New Roman is Serif, and Century Gothic is Sans-serif. **For data visualizations, or presentations, Sans-serif typefaces are favoured, while it's the reverse for printed documents.**
5. Advanced font options and customisations, such as controlling for *ligatures* connecting two letters, can be accessed in LibreOffice → Format → Character → Features (see Figure 2.5):

Make sure, if available, to download for each font, the regular, bold, italic-bold, and italic versions at the very least.

---

<sup>12</sup>Alternatively, you also have the native Fonts manager tool under GNOME launch start



Figure 2.5: Main typographic options



### 2.3.6 Docker

1. Download dependencies, configuration files and add repository to apt for automatic updates:

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt install ca-certificates curl ## dependencies for downloading packages, and verifying HTTPS p

## Part I: create, download and make Docker apt key readable for verifying its integrity
sudo install -m 0755 -d /etc/apt/keyrings
sudo curl -fsSL https://download.docker.com/linux/ubuntu/gpg -o /etc/apt/keyrings/docker.asc
sudo chmod a+r /etc/apt/keyrings/docker.asc

## Part II: define where, and which version of Docker, should be downloaded + how to verify its integ
sudo tee /etc/apt/sources.list.d/docker.sources <<EOF
Types: deb
URIs: https://download.docker.com/linux/ubuntu
Suites: $(. /etc/os-release && echo "${UBUNTU_CODENAME:-$VERSION_CODENAME}")
Components: stable
Signed-By: /etc/apt/keyrings/docker.asc ## folder previously defined
EOF

## Part III: update with newer configuration
sudo apt update
```

2. Install Docker toolkit with `sudo apt install docker-ce docker-ce-cli containerd.io docker-buildx-plugin docker-compose-plugin`
3. Run Docker without sudorights for the main laptop user:

```
# create a Unix group allowing Docker to interact with system-level resources without admin rights
sudo groupadd docker
# and add current user of the session to it
sudo usermod -aG docker $USER
```

## 2 Install core software on Ubuntu

4. Check installation with `sudo docker run hello-world`. If not running by default upon login, enable automated start with `sudo systemctl start docker`. More details [here](#).

Tutorials for Docker

- Benjamin presentation
- VsCode, R and Docker with DevContainers
- VsCode, Python and Docker with DevContainers
- DevContainers, from INRIA trainings

### 2.3.7 Teams

- Use the web version, as Microsoft no longer supports .deb versions for Linux.

### 2.3.8 Web browsers

#### 2.3.8.1 Firefox

Avoid running directly `sudo apt install firefox` -> it installs by default `snappd`, and will use not stable, beta Snap version of Firefox.

1. Import, and add Mozilla APT signing key:

```
## Download APT key
wget -q https://packages.mozilla.org/apt/repo-signing-key.gpg -O- | sudo tee /etc/ap

## Add it to the Apt registry
cat <<EOF | sudo tee /etc/apt/sources.list.d/mozilla.sources
Types: deb
URIs: https://packages.mozilla.org/apt
```

## 2.3 Software to install

```
Suites: mozilla
Components: main
Signed-By: /etc/apt/keyrings/packages.mozilla.org.asc
EOF

## Provide higher priority to Mozilla Firefox

echo '
Package: *
Pin: origin packages.mozilla.org
Pin-Priority: 1000
' | sudo tee /etc/apt/preferences.d/mozilla
```

2. Install Firefox using Mozilla provider:

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt install firefox

which firefox ## should not report `snapd` folder
apt policy firefox
```

### 2.3.8.2 Google Chrome

1. Install Google Chrome, by downloading the .deb archive, then run it:

```
sudo apt install google-chrome-stable_current_amd64.deb`
```

2. Download, and add Google Chrome APT signing key, for automatic updates:

## 2 Install core software on Ubuntu

```
## Download APT key
wget -q -O - https://dl.google.com/linux/linux_signing_key.pub | sudo gpg --dearmor

## Add it to the Apt registry
echo "deb [arch=amd64 signed-by=/usr/share/keyrings/google-linux-signing-key.gpg] ht

## Update to the most recent version
sudo apt update
```

3. add the *Grammarly* Chrome plug-in extension for automatic checking of the spelling, and grammar (choose one specific regional English, and stick to it)

### 2.3.9 Slack

1. Download Slack application
2. Run it with `sudo apt install slack-desktop-4.47.69-amd64.deb`
3. Update with:

```
sudo apt-get update
sudo apt-get upgrade slack-desktop
```

### 2.3.10 Zulip

1. Run following instructions:

```
sudo apt install curl ## if not already installed
sudo curl -fL -o /etc/apt/trusted.gpg.d/zulip-desktop.asc \
    https://download.zulip.com/desktop/apt/zulip-desktop.asc
echo "deb https://download.zulip.com/desktop/apt stable main" | \
```

```
sudo tee /etc/apt/sources.list.d/zulip-desktop.list
sudo apt update
sudo apt install zulip
```

2. Log-in (recommended with your Github profile) on each of the channels you want to connect, to keep notified about newest posts.

### 2.3.11 Cytoscape

Major default: only supported by Java version 17 (and not by more recent, and stable Java versions!!)

1. Install Java version 17 with `sudo apt install openjdk-17-jdk`<sup>13</sup>
2. Follow this tutorial
  - i. Retrieve the latest version
  - ii. Make it executable with `chmod u+x <filename.sh>`
  - iii. Run with `bash <filename.sh>`
  - iv. Launch with Cytoscape &.

### 2.3.12 Zotero

1. `sudo apt install libreoffice-java-common -y` adds Java dependencies to seamlessly integrate Zotero with Libre Office *plug-in* (for instance, automated retrieval of bibliographic references).
2. Retrieve the latest stable version on <https://www.zotero.org/download/><sup>14</sup>.
3. Run following instructions + Synchronise by installing Zotero Connector on your website:

---

<sup>13</sup>On Ubuntu, a more modern version of Java, the 21, was installed

<sup>14</sup>Alternatively, download with `curl`

## 2 Install core software on Ubuntu

```
#!/bin/bash

## part I: extract archive
sudo tar -xjf zotero.tar.bz2 -C /opt
sudo mv /opt/Zotero_linux-x86_64 /opt/zotero

## Part II: add the executable
sudo ln -s /opt/zotero/zotero /usr/local/bin/zotero
```

4. (Optional: add a custom Desktop, and launcher icon for an executable) Create file ~/.local/share/applications/zotero.desktop, with the following content. Make the launcher executable with `chmod +x ~/.local/share/applications/zotero.desktop`

```
[Desktop Entry]
Name=Zotero
Exec=/usr/local/bin/zotero
Icon=/opt/zotero/icons/icon128.png
StartupWMClass=Zotero
Type=Application
Terminal=false
Categories=Office;
MimeType=text/plain;x-scheme-handler/zotero;application/x-research-info-systems;text/x-zotero;
X-GNOME-SingleWindow=true
```

5. Inspired from Zotero hacks tutorial, enable unlimited synced storage for articles on multiple machines.
  - i. Add required plug-ins, **Better BibTeX** (mandatory for custom expert as a plain .bib file) + **Zotmoov**, which replaces previous extension **Zotfile** for classifying articles per author's name.

## 2.3 Software to install

- ii. Edit Zotero preferences<sup>15</sup>: - Uncheck the option to create automatic web page snapshots (increases cluttering with lots of small files added)  
- Uncheck full-text sync - Set apart in Edit->Settings->Advanced the
  - Base directory (should be the folder synced by your File sharing software), with
  - Custom Data directory location. This local folder should be located in a different position, and will be managed by Zotero itself

![Zotero Database Configuration](zotero-advanced-configuration.png)

- iii. Edit Better Bibtex *plug-in*: - Personally, use [auth:lower][year][journal:lower:abbr]  
- Should be the same across machines.

### 2.3.13 Quarto, R and RStudio

#### 2.3.13.1 R, and recommended packages

1. To get the latest R Versions, add the signing key, along with the repository:

```
sudo mkdir -p /etc/apt/keyrings
sudo wget -O /etc/apt/keyrings/cran.gpg https://cloud.r-project.org/bin/linux/ubuntu/marutter_pubkey.gpg
echo "deb [signed-by=/etc/apt/keyrings/cran.gpg] https://cloud.r-project.org/bin/linux/ubuntu jammy-cran40-bionic" >/etc/apt/sources.list.d/cran.list
```

2. Install R:

- i. Install basic dependencies

---

<sup>15</sup>What matters the most here is uniformity across platforms

## 2 Install core software on Ubuntu

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt install r-base r-base-dev -y
R --version
```

- ii. Install recommended Ubuntu system libraries for scientific computing and/or connection:

```
## Compilation tool
sudo apt install cmake

Network, imaging, and plotting libraries
sudo apt install \
build-essential \
libpng-dev \
libjpeg-dev \
libtiff-dev \
libcairo2-dev \
libcurl4-openssl-dev \
libssl-dev \
libxml2-dev \
zlib1g-dev

## scientific libraries
sudo apt install \
  build-essential \
  gfortran \
  libblas-dev \
  liblapack-dev \
  libgsl-dev
```

3. Configure default CRAN mirror.



## 2.3 Software to install

- i. default choice is <https://cloud.r-project.org>, as the official CRAN mirror, and the most up-to-date
- ii. For Ubuntu, the **Posit Package Manager** mirror, by providing prebuilt Linux binaries, is much faster to compile. To install it, modify the local `~/.Rprofile` file:

```
echo 'options(repos = c(CRAN = "https://packagemanager.posit.co/cran/__linux__/<ubuntu-version>/latest"))'
```

4. Install your packages, by organising them as a package repository with dependencies. Notably, install those of Stephen Turner, as essential to most bioinformatic pipelines:  
`remotes::install_github("stephenturner/Tverse", upgrade=TRUE).`

### 2.3.13.2 RStudio (Desktop IDE)

1. Go to: <https://www.rstudio.com/products/rstudio/download/#download/> Choose the **Ubuntu/Debian .deb package** for your architecture (amd64).
2. Install the .deb package:

```
sudo apt install ./rstudio-2025.09.0-422-amd64.deb
```

3. Install Air, as the recommended, fast and modern formatter for R code. Then, customise your RStudio settings, explicitly reporting the path location of Air formatter, see Tip 2.

```
uv tool install air-formatter
```

### Tip 2: Sync RStudio options across platforms

1. **Locate the repository on your system that stores RStudio settings.** There's no direct means for exporting RStudio parameters that have been modified by the user. Instead, the key directory storing core RStudio settings is located under `~/.config/rstudio/` for Linux, and `%AppData%\RStudio` for Windows<sup>16</sup>. The key files in this repository are:

| File                            | Purpose                                        |
|---------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| <code>rstudio-prefs.json</code> | Global preferences modified by the user        |
| <code>keybindings/</code>       | Custom keyboard shortcuts                      |
| <code>themes/</code>            | Custom themes (if any)                         |
| <code>snippets/</code>          | Code snippets                                  |
| <code>dictionaries/</code>      | Custom dictionaries beyond English, and French |

2. **Identify what it's worth relevant for syncing:** indeed, while you could export all the RStudio settings for a complete backup, most of them are optional, or barely modified by regular users. Instead, I would identify, and retrieve only the settings explicitly changed by the user. > Would use local, or online diff editors, such as diffcheckers to quickly identify what changed between personal configurations. > Specifically, all external tools that complement the functionalities of RStudio, such as pdf previewer, or external formatters such as Air, are hard-coded as absolute paths, and are accordingly highly specific to a personal laptop.
3. **Homogenise settings across machines:** once you've finalised the customisation of the RStudio settings to your specific OS configuration, simply overwrite pre-existing *user-specific* settings file `rstudio-prefs.json`. **Restart RStudio** to check if changes were properly integrated into the graphical interface<sup>17</sup>.

To simplify the syncing across machines (especially for teams with shared computing environment), use either:

1. Git-based sync, storing your dotfiles. This is the recommended approach. You can find my settings files under `rstudio-prefs.json`. See also Figure 2.6 for a more comprehensive explanation of core changes brought to a default, native RStudio configuration.
2. use symbolic links, or cloud sync (but you have fewer options to adjust for changes)

## 2 Install core software on Ubuntu

The image shows a screenshot of the RStudio .Rprofile file, which is used to configure the default behavior of RStudio. The file is divided into several sections, each with a title in a different color. The sections are:

- In yellow, reproducibility options**: This section contains options for reproducibility, such as `options(repos = c(CRAN = "https://cloud.r-project.org/"))` and `options(make.names = "preserve")`.
- In green, compatibility across OS, and R version**: This section contains options for compatibility across different operating systems and R versions, such as `options(bitmapType = "cairo")` and `options(java.library.path = "/usr/lib/jvm/java-8-openjdk-amd64/bin/../lib")`.
- Format code with air on save**: This section contains options for formatting code, such as `options(air.format.on.save = TRUE)`.
- Integrate RStudio with GH Copilot**: This section contains options for integrating RStudio with GitHub Copilot, such as `options(gh.copilot.enabled = TRUE)`.

(a) In yellow, core reproducibility options. Notably, avoid loading your R session, and objects on start, for reduced use of memory

(b) Styling and linting of R code with Air Posit, and integration with AI helpers.

Figure 2.6: Core options to change the default behaviour of RStudio, enabling enhanced compatibility across projects, R Versions, and OS platforms.

Controversial claim: use VScode for R development if working inside a Docker container, or on a server that does not provide a RStudio interface, otherwise, it's overkilled. Notably, for R package development, that should be containerised, RStudio is way more flexible

### 2.3.13.3 Quarto

Go to <https://quarto.org/docs/get-started/>

<sup>17</sup>%AppData% is a shortened alias for this expanded path on Windows:  
C:\Users\<YourUser>\AppData\Roaming\RStudio

<sup>18</sup>If some of the setting changes were not applied, you can usually access them from the Menu options with Tools > Global Options...

## 2.3 Software to install

```
sudo apt install ./quarto-1.3.496-linux-amd64.deb
quarto check
```

$$a = 10$$

### 2.3.13.4 Cursor with R

1. Install the following R packages:

```
install.packages("remotes")
library(languageserver)
library(rmarkdown)
library(vscDebugger)
library(httpgd)
```

2. (optional, but recommended) Use **radianas** enhanced R terminal with  
`uv tool install radian`
3. Install the **vscDebugger** extension for VS Code, and run the debug demo script to test it.

| R Debugger — RStudio vs VS Code / Cursor                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                              |                                 |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| Five shared actions, one keyboard shortcut each                                                                                                                          |                                                                                              |                                 |
| RStudio                                                                                                                                                                  | Action                                                                                       | VS Code / Cursor                |
| 1—STEP OVER<br>↶ + <b>n</b>   Next                                                                                                                                       | <b>Step Over</b><br>result <- my_func(x) # ← steps OVER my_func                              | ↶ + <b>F10</b>   Step Over      |
| 2—STEP INTO<br>↶ + <b>s</b>   Step Into                                                                                                                                  | <b>Step Into</b><br>result <- my_func(x) # ← steps INTO my_func                              | ↓ + <b>F11</b>   Step Into      |
| 3—STEP OUT / FINISH<br>↶ + <b>f</b>   Finish                                                                                                                             | <b>Step Out</b><br># inside my_func() body<br># ← exits back to caller                       | ↑ + <b>Shift+F11</b>   Step Out |
| 4—CONTINUE<br>▶ + <b>c</b>   Continue                                                                                                                                    | <b>Continue</b><br>browser() # pause 1<br># ... code ...<br>browser() # pause 2 ← jumps here | ▶ + <b>F5</b>   Continue        |
| 5—STOP<br>■ + <b>Q</b>   Stop                                                                                                                                            | <b>Stop / Quit</b><br># exits debug mode<br># returns to normal R session                    | ■ + <b>Shift+F5</b>   Stop      |
| ⓘ <b>VS Code only — Reload Sources (U)</b> : reloads the file after edits without restarting the session<br>Edit debug_demo.R → click U → breakpoints update immediately |                                                                                              |                                 |

Figure 2.7: Side by side comparison of the debug demo script, and the debugger in action

2.3.14 Python

From **PEP 668**. guidelines, applied to modern Debian/Ubuntu distributions with native Python installed above the 3.11/3.12 version, **pip** is prevented from modifying the **system Python** as it could interfere with te core installation program **apt**.

This section is certainly the most controversial of this whole Ubuntu tutorial, as guidelines for a modern programmatic use of Python evolve rapidly, without reaching a full agreement

## 2.3.14.1 Python tools

## 💡 Modern Python development guidelines

1. The latest versions of Ubuntu, including **Noble**, strongly deter from installing system-wide versions of recent Python packages. In other words, avoid running `sudo apt install python3.14-full`, and updating Deadsnakes PPA.
2. `uv` fully replaces the functionalities and features brought by a variety of slower, standalone Python tools (`pip`, `poetry`, `virtualenv`, `pipx`, ...), providing a faster, versatile and unified framework, see Figure ?? **The features provided by `poetry` for package development may still not be fully covered by `uv`, and `pip` remains the legacy solution in older HPC systems:**

```

/usr/bin ### Pre-installed Ubuntu system
└─ system Python (used by OS)

uv
├─ managed Python versions
├─ CLI tools (black, ruff, jupyterlab)
└─ project environments

~/.local/share/uv/python/
└─ python3.14

```

3. `conda`, and even `mamba` have been outdated by `pixi` for multi-language projects. **`uv` is definitely the go-to solution for Python-centric projects, but does not support yet cross-language project managements.** Of note, `uv` natively enforces the use of virtual environments when running Python scripts, see Table ??.

## 2 Install core software on Ubuntu

4. The field renews fast -> stay alert, and up-to-date to the latest trends in this tech world.

| Feature                 | uv         | Poetry | Pixi    |
|-------------------------|------------|--------|---------|
| Speed                   |            |        |         |
| Dependency management   |            |        |         |
| Virtual environments    |            |        |         |
| Python version install  |            |        |         |
| Package publishing      | Acceptable | Best   | Limited |
| Non-Python dependencies |            |        |         |
| CI performance          |            |        |         |
| Maturity                | Medium     | High   | Medium  |

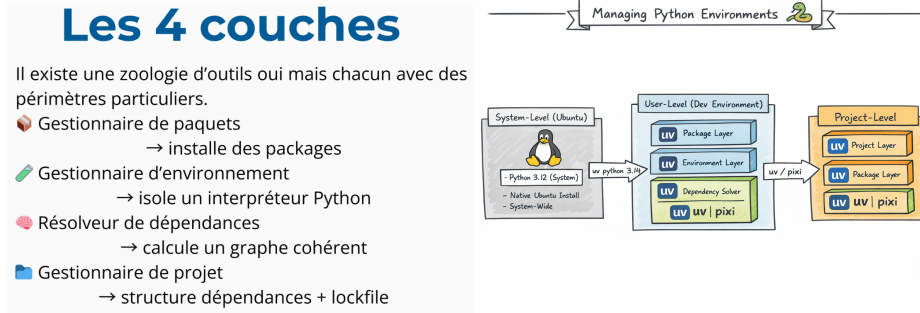
### 2.3.14.2 One Tool to bring them all and in the jungle of Python tool, bind them all: a uv story plot

I now describe the core steps to use the latest stable Python version (currently, 3.14), without breaking core Linux dependencies using pre-installed Python version.

1. Install uv with the following command: `curl -LsSf https://astral.sh/uv/install.sh | sh`.
2. Install latest Python version with uv: `uv python install 3.14`.
3. Two configuration levels for setting up the Python version
  - i. At the project level, run `uv python pin 3.14`.
  - ii. At the user level: `bash cd ~ echo "3.14" > ~/.python-version`
4. Use uv instead of pipx to install core Python tools for package dependency, web IDEs, modern Python formatting and styling, .... As pipx, all these tools are automatically added to the user's PATH:



## 2.3 Software to install



- (a) Each tool used to have its perimeter, hence the diversity of Python execs
- (b) The three levels of Python environments, from system-wide (not to be modified) to the project level

|               | Paquets | Env | Resolver   | Projet |
|---------------|---------|-----|------------|--------|
| <b>pip</b>    | ✓       | ✗   | ✓          | ✗      |
| <b>venv</b>   | ✗       | ✓   | ✗          | ✗      |
| <b>conda</b>  | ✓       | ✓   | ✓          | ✗      |
| <b>mamba</b>  | ✓       | ✓   | ✓ (rapide) | ✗      |
| <b>poetry</b> | ✓       | ✓   | ✓          | ✓      |
| <b>uv</b>     | ✓       | ✓   | ✓ (rapide) | ✓      |
| <b>pixi</b>   | ✓       | ✓   | ✓          | ✓      |

- (c) Side-by-side compariosn of the core use cases of each Python tool -> uv supersedes them all.

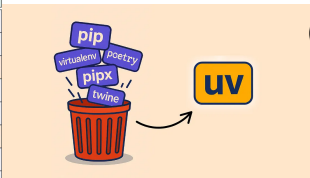
Figure 2.8: Comparison of Python managers.

2 Install core software on Ubuntu

uv Cheatsheet for Python Developers

| Command                            | Description                                                                                                  |
|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| uv init <project-name>             | Initialize a new Python project with default structure                                                       |
| uv venv                            | Create a new virtual environment in the current project                                                      |
| uv add <package-name>              | Add a package to the project's dependencies                                                                  |
| uv pip install -r requirements.txt | Install all packages from a requirements file                                                                |
| uv remove <package-name>           | Delete a package from the project's dependencies                                                             |
| uv run script.py                   | Run a Python script or command inside the project's environment                                              |
| uv sync                            | Install all dependencies to match the uv.lock file                                                           |
| uv tool install <tool-name>        | Install a Python CLI application as a global tool. Example: uv tool install ruff                             |
| uv <tool> [args]                   | Execute a Python CLI tool in an ephemeral environment without installing it. For example: uv black script.py |

(a) Main commands to replace old-fahsioned Python tools by uv.



(b) Caricature illustrating the recent domination of uv



(c) Decision tree for the choice of Python tool, depending on the scope: uv for pure Python projects (for instance, running bioinformatic analyses), poetry (and uv with less support) for Python packages, and pixi for cross-language projects. \*\*Note that both conda and mamba are no longer required in the modern Programmer stack.

## 2.3 Software to install

```
uv tool install ruff ## ~ equivalent to pipx install ruff
uv tool install black
uv tool install jupyterlab ## `JupyterLab` outdates previous `JupyterNotebook` as a web-based, and use
uv tool install ipython
uv tool install pre-commit
uv tool install poetry
uv tool install cookiecutter `Cookiecutter` generates Python templates for modern packaging.
```

### 💡 Python version management: core checks

- Check integrity of system Python:

```
ls /usr/bin/python* ## -> ## only one version expected, Python 3.12 with modern Linux
/usr/bin/python3.12
```

- Check version used by uv:

```
ls -la ~/.local/share/uv/python* ## path returned should be located within the HOME directory
```

---

Checking current Python version used:

- From the terminal (system-wide), `ls -d /usr/lib/python3.*`, or `which -a python` should only return a unique version of Python, the one used by Ubuntu.
- From a Python shell (including Jupyter Lab):

```
import sys
print(sys.version)
print(sys.executable)
print(sys.path)
```

## 2 Install core software on Ubuntu

Relevant sources for Python tools

- From Pip to Lightning: How uv Opened My Eyes to Better Python Workflows
- LinkedIn portfolio on Python dependencies management tools

### 2.3.14.3 Marimo to replace Jupyter-Lab

1. Install Marimo, including commonly used tools: duckdb (SQL cells), polars/pyarrow (SQL output), ruff (formatting), vegafusion (charts)

```
uv tool install "marimo[recommended]"

# Verify
marimo --version
```

2. Add Cursor/VS Code extension:

```
cursor --install-extension marimo-team.vscode-marimo
```

3. Commonly used keybindings to be added:

```
// --- ☐ Marimo ---
// Open current .py file as a marimo notebook in the editor
{
  "key": "ctrl+alt+m",
  "command": "marimo.openNotebook",
  "when": "resourceExtname == '.py'"
},
// Create a new sandboxed marimo notebook via terminal
{
```

```
"key": "ctrl+alt+shift+m",
"command": "workbench.action.terminal.sendSequence",
"args": { "text": "uvx marimo edit --sandbox \\n" }
},
// Run current marimo notebook as a read-only app
{
  "key": "ctrl+alt+r",
  "command": "workbench.action.terminal.sendSequence",
  "when": "resourceExtname == '.py'",
  "args": { "text": "uvx marimo run '${file}'\\n" }
}
```

4. Interactive example is provided in demo.py.

### 2.3.15 Nextflow as workflow management tool

Installation process as standalone, and automatically up-to-date tool. `µpCheck` first that Java version at least 17 is installed, see Section 2.3.11:

```
curl -s https://get.nextflow.io | bash
chmod +x nextflow # make nextflow executable

# move nextflow into executbale path
sudo mv nextflow $HOME/.local/bin/
```

### 2.3.16 Latex

```
sudo apt install texlive-full -y
## other commonly used packages
sudo apt install texlive-latex-extra texlive-fonts-recommended texlive-science biber latexmk -y
```

## 2 Install core software on Ubuntu

### 2.3.17 WhatsApp

- No supported local Linux installation
- Instead, recommended to use the Web version of WhatsApp, then pair it with your mobile device.

### 2.3.18 Cursor

1. Download DEB extension.
2. Run it:

```
sudo apt install ./cursor_2.0.77_amd64.deb
```

3. Sync your Cursor configuration across devices, see Tip 3:



#### Tip 3: Export Cursor settings

1. Export the core settings:
  - i. Open Command Palette (`Ctrl/Cmd + Shift + P`), then search: **\*\*“Preferences: Open Settings (JSON)”**
  - ii. Export the file in your new device
  - iii. Default Linux installation: `~/.config/Cursor/User/settings.json``
2. Export the keybinding shortcuts:
  - i. Open: **“Preferences: Open Keyboard Shortcuts (JSON)”**
  - ii. Export `keybindings.json` into your local folder:  
`~/.config/Cursor/User/keybindings.json`
3. **(the main difference with VSCode)**. Contrary to VSCode, you need to export the list of extensions manually:
  - i. Retrieve the list of extensions running `cursor --list-extensions > extensions.txt`

ii. Install them back with:

```
grep -v '^$*#' "~/config/Cursor/User/extensions.txt" \  
| grep -v '^$*$' \  
| xargs -I{} cursor --install-extension {}
```

4. The whole list of extensions, and Cursor settings are available under the Cursor config folder.

More details are provide in *Sync Cursor Settings the Dotfiles Way* website, including the symlink commands to fully automate this process

The hardcore way, for syncing configuration files across numerous users, cf Benjamin, and Cursor Config Sync

### 2.3.19 Password Manager for Linux -> BitWarden

BitWarden is the recommended password manager for Linux systems for a variety of reasons: it's mostly free, compliant with most web browsers (Firefox, Chrome, Opera, ...), including native Google password manager, and can sync your password database over an endless number of devices. There's even a lightweight application for Iphone, and Android mobile phones. Besides, the storage extends beyond raw passwords, ranging from passkeys, to SSH secrets, or credit card information. Finally, it's compatible with most OS, including Windows and Linux.

Accordingly, all these features further expand the facilities delivered by native Ubuntu Gnome **Passwords** and **Keys** application manager, which besides can only be installed locally.

## 2 Install core software on Ubuntu

One major drawback, though, is that it does not check for duplicated values in an automated way.

Follow the following steps for its installation<sup>18</sup>

```
## Install Flatpak, and Gnome Flatpak plugin
sudo apt install flatpak
sudo apt install gnome-software-plugin-flatpak

## Add Flatbu repository for software storage
flatpak remote-add --if-not-exists flathub https://dl.flathub.org/repo/flathub.flatpak

## Install and run BitWarden locally
flatpak install flathub com.bitwarden.desktop
flatpak run com.bitwarden.desktop

## Install Web Add-on, going to https://chromewebstore.google.com/detail/bitwarden-pa

## Export, then import your password database from other web browsers
```

In the Auto-fill tab of the Parameters configuration, leave unticked the option Do not auto-fill on page load + choose Default URI detection option as Exact to avoid ambiguities. Counterintuitively, go to Web Vault BitWarden to bulk remove passwords. This option is not proposed by default in the regular BitWarden.

## 2.4 Core numerical tools provided by AMU

List of numerical tools used in Amu

---

<sup>18</sup>Contrary to best guidelines suggested in Note 1, only the flatpak and snap installation are supported for Ubuntu devices -> no automatic updates with native apt Ubuntu dependency manager



### 2.4.1 AMUZoom

1. Retrieve latest version, choosing proper Linux distributions and OS architecture under Zoom downloads. Also available online. Strongly recommended to install Zoom locally.
2. Run `sudo apt install ./zoom_amd64.deb`
3. **Log-in using your university email address, using SSO.** The account is provided with unlimited meetings available by default, use following domain: `univ-amu-fr`.<sup>19</sup>

2 elements, listed below, to keep in mind, when creating a Zoom meeting to enable any external user, with the password, to log-in, and share its screen, see Figure 2.10:

To go further, check the following online resources:

- Guidelines for Zoom Meeting creation, and management
- Video tutorial
- Guidelines for students

### 2.4.2 WooClap for QCMs

Go to WooClap, and use your **institutional mail address** for single sign-on across platforms.

---

<sup>19</sup>Alternatively, use the web version available [here](#)

## 2 Install core software on Ubuntu

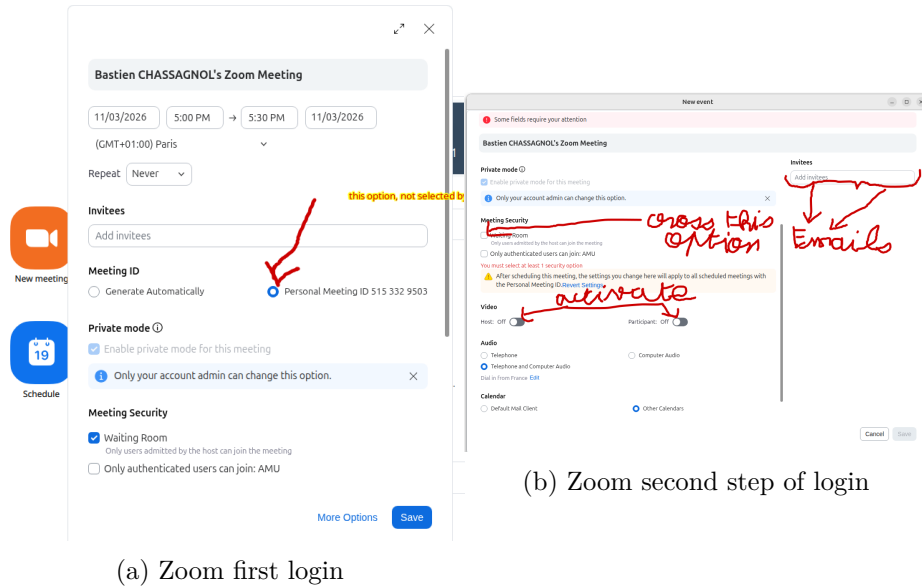


Figure 2.10: Be careful about selecting the second, non-default option, if you want to allow external users without any Amu mail address to connect on your Zoom session.

## 2.5 Working with a remote server

**i** Retrive its identity on the server

```
id ${USER}
uid=1001(bastien) gid=1001(bastien) groups=1001(bastien),4(adm),24(cdrom),27(sudo),30(dip),46(plugdev)
```

- list of groups on the server, identify is defined by the combination of an username, UID (user ID), and GID (group ID) on both servers.

```
id ${USER}
uid=1007(bastienc) gid=1007(bastienc) groupes=1007(bastienc),1043(dtoo_project)
```

More information available under Server Management tutorial.

### 2.5.1 SSH configuration

Objective is dual: avoid typing your password each time you're connecting to a remote cluster, and keep a safe storage of all registered remote hosts:

1. Set up SSH remote access (with key-based auth)

```
## remote server must have openssh-server installed
sudo apt install openssh-server
```

2. Generate a pair of public-private SSH key on your local machine<sup>20</sup>

---

<sup>20</sup>Using a passphrase is not compulsory, but safer

## 2 Install core software on Ubuntu

```
ssh-keygen -t ed25519 -C "your_email@example.com"
```

This creates:

- `~/.ssh/id_ed25519`` (private key)
  - `~/.ssh/id_ed25519.pub`` (public key)
3. Copy your key to the server with `ssh-copy-id username@server_ip`. You'll no longer need typing your password once typed once.
  4. (Optional) Keep under `~/.ssh/config` file the key features describing each remote cluster. For instance, my configuration for the IFB is the following, and to connect to it, I only need typing now `ssh ifb-core`. A second advantage of using this format for storing hosts is that it can be readily used by VS Code SSH Remote connection extensions.

```
## □ alias for the host connection, either "ifb-core" or "ifb"
Host ifb-core ifb

## □ The real hostname (or IP) of the remote server
HostName core.cluster.france-bioinformatique.fr

## □ Username used on the remote machine
User bchassagnol

## □ Path to your private SSH key
IdentityFile ~/.ssh/id_ed25519

## □ Force SSH to use ONLY the specified key above, avoiding complex managing of keys
IdentitiesOnly yes

## □ Order of authentication methods: SSH key, then keyboard-interactive, then fallback
PreferredAuthentications publickey,keyboard-interactive,password
```

## 2.5 Working with a remote server

```
## □ Automatically add this key to ssh-agent when used
AddKeysToAgent yes

# Host configuration for the new server
Host mmg-sb-05 new-mmg-cluster
HostName 139.124.156.52
Port 22218 # is the port, avoiding, unlike the popular 22, to be hacked.
User bastienc
IdentityFile ~/.ssh/id_ed25519
IdentitiesOnly yes
PubkeyAuthentication yes
PreferredAuthentications publickey,keyboard-interactive,password
AddKeysToAgent yes
ForwardX11 yes
ForwardX11Trusted yes
```

My host configuration, enabling by default graphical interfaces to run on the remote server, is available under config-ssh

---

### Ssh configuration recommendations

On older Ubuntu configurations, the `ssh-agent`, and `ssh-add` processes are not activated by default on startup. Check this by running `systemctl --user enable ssh-agent`.

Report to Table ??, and Figure 2.11 for further details

---

## 2 Install core software on Ubuntu

| Practice                            | Why                                                         |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Prefer Ed25519 keys</b>          | Small, fast, modern default.                                |
| <b>Use a pass phrase on the key</b> | Protects the key if the disk is copied or stolen.           |
| <b>~/.ssh/config per host</b>       | Aliases, and login recommendations                          |
| <b>Never commit private keys</b>    | Keep <code>id_*</code> out of git and cloud-synced folders. |
| <b>ssh-copy-id once per host</b>    | Standard way to populate <code>authorized_keys</code> .     |

## 2.5 Working with a remote server

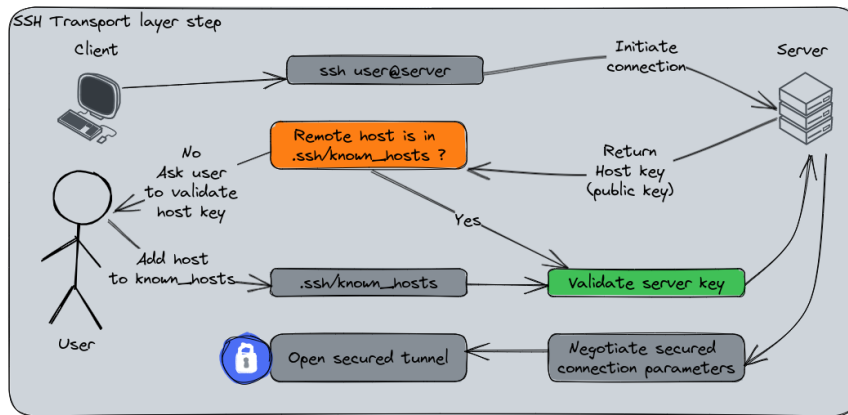


Figure 2.11: Overview of an initial SSH connection

| Option | Purpose                    | Effect on X11                                                    |
|--------|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| -X     | X11 forwarding (untrusted) | Runs GUI apps remotely                                           |
| -Y     | X11 forwarding (trusted)   | Runs all GUI apps remotely                                       |
| -C     | Compression                | Reduces network usage and can speed up GUI over slow connections |

### 2.5.2 MMG cluster, and recommendations for project management

About projects timeline, and structure, follow these tips as soon as *collaboration* is involved:

- Initiate `git + github` at the real start up of the project
- Use only the `/mnt/<cluster-name>/projects/` folder (no projects in your home, except for a quick run, and test)
- When creating the project, set carefully group and user permissions, following guidelines of document [https://github.com/BAUDOTlab/teaching\\_material/blob/main/Server%20Management/Server\\_Management.pdf](https://github.com/BAUDOTlab/teaching_material/blob/main/Server%20Management/Server_Management.pdf), section **Creating a New Project**
- Complement the `README.md` (to be created) at the root of the folder, with one short line per directory in the `projects` folder quickly summarising the overarching objective of the study

`~/remote_project ->`

Upon my recent transition from the Windows world to Linux, and huge frustration resulting from spending a lot of time recovering tutorials and disseminated configuration files when configuring a new laptop, here's my detailed tutorial about best practices when starting from fresh on a Ubuntu session: [https://baudotlab.github.io/teaching\\_material/Linux/installation-linux.html](https://baudotlab.github.io/teaching_material/Linux/installation-linux.html) (and GH repo: [https://github.com/BAUDOTlab/teaching\\_material](https://github.com/BAUDOTlab/teaching_material)) Beyond key commands, I distil some tips to enhance reproducibility across projects, provide default configuration tools for Git, RStudio and VS Code, and suggest software to replace the paying licence of the Office ecosystem. I also tried to concatenate recommendations from the team, including Benjamin, Morgane, Marielle, and philippe notably.

Besides, here are the 3 development guidelines that after discussions with Benjamin, might be the most controversial, but strongly suggest nonetheless:



## 2.5 Working with a remote server

- No further support of RServer, nor JupyterLab on the server -> with VS Code, and its extension “Visual Studio Code Remote - SSH”, it’s easy to automatically retrieve back its local programming framework
  - For Python, switch to VS Code (or Cursor for AI-guided development): **Spyder** is slow, and old-looking, **Jupyter Notebooks** is not reproducible (and limited in functionalities), especially with the advent of Marimo: <https://marimo.io/>, **PyCharm**, while offering a slightly better developer experience, has a paying licence that limits its functionalities + all its features are covered by VS Code extensions
  - For R, **RStudio** is definitely the best (to quote Benjamin, “that’s the utmost shame that the best IDE had been developed for the worst programming language”). But running it on the server implies strong latency -> suggested workflow: develop, and run your scripts on small examples locally, then scale them on larger datasets using VS Code on the server (or the command line)
- Use **uv** for Python-full projects, **uv** or **poetry** for Python package development, and **pixi** for multi-language projects (see why in following caricature) -> especially, both **conda** and **mamba** are heavy, and way too slow
- About projects timeline, and structure, follow these tips as soon as collaboration is involved:
  - Initiate **git + github** at the real start up of the project
  - Use only the **/mnt/<cluster-name>/projects/** folder (no projects in your home, except for a quick run, and test)
  - When creating the project, set carefully group and user permissions, following guidelines of document [https://github.com/BAUDOTlab/teaching\\_material/blob/main/Server%20Management/Server\\_Management.pdf](https://github.com/BAUDOTlab/teaching_material/blob/main/Server%20Management/Server_Management.pdf), section **Creating a New Project**

## 2 Install core software on Ubuntu

- Complement the `README.md` (to be created) at the root of the folder, with one short line per directory in the `projects` folder quickly summarising the overarching objective of the study

Finally, if you: - Want to collaborate to the tutorial: favour quarto (or notebooks) editable files over PDFs, index your document under [https://github.com/BAUDOTlab/teaching\\_material/blob/main/\\_quarto.yml](https://github.com/BAUDOTlab/teaching_material/blob/main/_quarto.yml). You can also report issues directly on the website, clicking on the option “Edit this page” in the footer - For computational nerds, or people generally interested in best programming guidelines, solving computational and dependency nightmares, or simply curious, add a like to this comment -> I’ll add a Slack channel to unify debates, and troubleshoot issue solving :-)